

Netflix scores with 2 NFL games

Christmas matchups plus Beyoncé show mark a milestone for streaming industry.

By SAMANTHA MASUNAGA AND RYAN FAUGHNDER

With two much anticipated NFL games and a big assist from Beyoncé, Netflix created a major cultural moment for the streaming industry, marking a significant milestone as the service pushes further into live sports. But the events couldn't top the ratings for last year's games on broadcast television.

Netflix on Thursday said its two Christmas Day NFL games — Kansas City Chiefs versus Pittsburgh Steelers and Baltimore Ravens versus Houston Texans — each brought tens of millions of viewers to the Los Gatos, Calif.-based streaming service.

The Ravens-Texans game drew an average of 24.3 million U.S. viewers Wednesday, and the earlier Chiefs-Steelers matchup brought in 24.1 million, according to Nielsen data released by Netflix. Viewership peaked with 27 million viewers during the Ravens-Texans game with Beyoncé's halftime performance, the company said. Worldwide streaming numbers will be released in the coming days.

The strong numbers [See **Netflix**, A8]

Florida's star rises under Trump

Election result shifts power in the rivalry of Sunshine State versus Golden State.

By NOAH BIERMAN

WASHINGTON — The rivalry between California and Florida reached a high mark in November 2023 when Gov. Gavin Newsom, a Democrat, faced off against Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis, a Republican, on Fox News over which state held a better model for the country.

Thirteen months later, DeSantis has left the national stage after an aborted presidential run. But his state is winning the political war.

The nation under President-elect Donald Trump will look far more like Trump's adopted home state of Florida, after he defeated Vice President Kamala Harris by painting her as an out-of-touch California liberal.

Trump is stocking his Cabinet with Floridians. And his plans to reverse California's policies on the environment, crime, homelessness and education are facing far less pushback than they did during his first term, thanks to the state's [See **Rivalry**, A8]



PRISONER MarKeisha Dixon, center, is one of the peer support specialists helping other inmates at the lockup in Chowchilla, Calif. Photographs by GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

Transforming California's dark prison culture and the women in it

CHOWCHILLA, Calif. — Gazing across the crowd of women, fresh from county jail in their orange prison jumpsuits, Lena Coleman wishes she could save them all.

And it's her job to try.

In July, after 20 years in prison for attempted murder and a gun enhancement, Coleman, 47, became one of three dozen prisoners at the Central California Women's Facility in Chowchilla to graduate from a peer support specialist program.

The program is a part of the California Model, an ambitious effort Gov. Gavin Newsom launched in March 2023 to overhaul a prison system built on fear and retribution and replace it with opportunities for more normalized social interaction. The changes are modeled after prison operations in Norway and other Scandinavian countries, where incarceration is considered a tool for rehabilitation rather than harsh punishment.

At Chowchilla, a sprawling campus set in the farm fields of Madera County, the

Officials and trained inmates in Chowchilla are applying a new model of rehabilitation. They have to face traumas inside and out.

By Hannah Wiley



PEER SUPPORT specialists act as something between therapist and life coach to the 2,100 inmates at the Central California Women's Facility.

peer support specialists have become the backbone of that transformation.

Every day, they fan out across the prison, serving as something between a therapist and life coach to the roughly 2,100 women incarcerated at the facility, one of two women's prisons in California.

Coleman works in Building 501, a reception yard that houses new prisoners before they transfer "over the wall" into the general population.

Her job is often limited in scope: helping a new arrival find prison garb that fits, or working with the healthcare services team to remind patients to take their medicine or attend an upcoming medical appointment.

Other times, the work requires more intense intervention.

Staff might call a peer support specialist to help de-escalate violence or ease a behavioral crisis. As mandated reporters, they can be the difference between someone dying of suicide or accepting mental health [See **Prison**, A6]

Israel bombs key sites in Yemen

World Health Organization chief and U.N. staff safe after strikes on airport, multiple harbors. **WORLD**, A3

Expert's take on seasonal viruses

What to know about the latest infectious-disease trends and best practices to slow their spread. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

The rising cost of air travel

Deals are expected to grow scarcer as major airlines go premium and budget carriers struggle. **BUSINESS**, A7

Weather
Cloudy; high waves. L.A. Basin: 66/50. **B6**

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Ripple effects of children's book bans

Efforts by conservative parents have tanked sales. Culture-war-weary schools and libraries are shunning materials on LGBTQ+ issues, race.

By JENNY GOLD

After years of culture war battles in school and public libraries, the campaign by conservative-leaning "parent rights" groups has succeeded in casting a nationwide chill over the market for children's books they deem inappropriate, greatly diminishing sales and opportunities for authors to promote their work.

During the 2023-24 school year, there were more than 10,000 book bans in public schools — a 200% rise over the previous year. The books overwhelmingly included LGBTQ+ themes and characters of color, according to PEN America. Many of the same books are banned over and over across the country, through coordinated efforts by groups that share lists of titles among their members, including picture and board books for preschool children.

In what some in the book publishing industry call "shadow bans" or "soft censorship," the effects are [See **Book bans**, A5]



MAUREEN PALACIOS of Once Upon a Time bookstore in Montrose said some schools have hesitated to purchase books with LGBTQ+ themes. JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times



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